

FROM SONNET CLUB NETS TO IPL STARDOM

Mayank Yadav may have just made his IPL debut, but his searing pace and accuracy have **already earned him** plenty of admirers on and off the pitch.

SPORTSPICS / IPL

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He caught Tarak Sinha's attention at the Sonnet Club nets six years ago. Sinha could not take his eyes off this lanky, consistently quick bowler. In fact he was so impressed with his talent that he had instructed the Sonnet Club officials to not charge any fees from him. For Sinha's assistant, Davendra Sharma, the boy looked like a discovery worth investing in. "He had walked in with his father (Prabhu). Mayank's determination to play for Delhi was evident in his approach. The senior

group noticed him, and soon he rattled them with his raw pace. We found a fantastic talent, and I am glad he built on the guidance from Ustaad Ji (Sinha)," recalled Sharma.

"I always wanted my son to play cricket, and that too as a fast bowler," said Prabhu Yadav, who ensured he provided Mayank with the platform to chase his cricketing dreams. Prabhu was self-employed, manufacturing sirens and lights for police vehicles.

"I went to a club in West Delhi where he was not encouraged even to join, let alone play. Then I heard of the Sonnet Club, where Mr. Sinha was famous for being an unbiased coach. That was the best decision of

my life, and I chose to take Mayank to Mr. Sinha. That was the only time I went with him to the club because I was assured that Mr. Sinha and Davendra Ji were the best people to care for my son," said Prabhu.

Mayank's blistering pace in Delhi caused discomfort for the batters. And he relished the challenge on the grandest stage, as demonstrated in his standout performance for the Lucknow Super Giants against the Punjab Kings in the 2024 Indian Premier League match.

The ball thudded onto the bat as Mayank bowled with a splendid rhythm.

"His rhythm is his strength," said Gursharan Singh, who pushed for